JIAMIN ZHAO

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Address: IESE Business School, Av. Pearson 21, 08034 Barcelona, Spain

Education

Ph.D. in Accounting *Expected 2027*
IESE Business School, Spain
Advisors: Professor Gaizka Ormazabal and Professor Igor Kadach

M.Sc. in Accounting *2020*
Xiamen University, China
Exchange Student, **Korea University Business School**, South Korea *Feb.–Jul. 2019*

B.Sc. in Economics *2015*
Major: Finance
Shanghai Maritime University, China
Minor: Accounting *2014*
Shanghai University of Finance and Economics, China

Research Interests

My research examines how stakeholder, labor-market, and technological environments shape corporate disclosure and information strategies.

Research

Job Market Paper

"Public Activism and Labor-related Corporate Disclosure", single-authored

Abstract: This paper examines how the surrounding public environment shapes labor-related corporate disclosure. Greater non-firm-specific labor public activism around corporate headquarters is associated with less discussion of current labor-related operating conditions relative to talent-management information in subsequent earnings calls. The findings show that firms adjust disclosure to changes in the surrounding public environment even when the underlying activism does not directly target the firm.

Award: *The Sue Hrasky Best PhD Paper Prize, BAFA, 2026*
Selected Presentations: *EAA Doctoral Colloquium 2026, IESE Seminar 2026, BAFA Annual Conference 2026, JIAR Annual Conference 2026, University of Zurich DAR Workshop 2025*

Other Research

"Mapping Corporate Digital Information-Access Policies: Evidence from Web Access Directives", with Long Cheng and Igor Kadach

Manuscript in preparation.

Abstract: This paper constructs a novel historical measure of corporate information-access policies

from 2001 to 2024. We document how public firms govern automated access to information on their websites, characterize the long-run evolution and composition of these policies, and validate the measure using externally documented changes in web-access rules. The evidence reveals a previously underexplored dimension of corporate information policy: firms not only decide what information to make public, but also govern the scope and terms of automated access to that information.

Publications

"Same Interdependent Risk, Different Valuation: How Risk Representation Shapes Ecosystem Investment Decisions"
Shiyao Bao, **Jiamin Zhao**, En Yang, Llewellyn D. W. Thomas, Hansjörg Neth, Jan K. Woike, and Sebastian Hafenbrädl
Journal of Management Scientific Reports, 4(4), 414–443, 2026

Work in Progress

"Stakeholder Pressure and the Supply of Corporate Information", single-authored

Abstract: This paper examines how firms adjust disclosure when directly targeted by stakeholder pressure. Labor targeting is associated with less discussion of labor operating conditions, whereas environmental targeting is associated with more climate-transition discussion. Employee reviews further suggest that labor targeting is accompanied by greater employee-generated discussion of labor issues. The findings highlight how stakeholder pressure can elicit different information responses from managers and employees, reshaping the composition and sources of corporate information.

"Protecting Information Without Disclosing Less: Governing the Downstream Use of Corporate Information", with Long Cheng

Abstract: This project examines whether firms can protect the proprietary value of information without reducing public disclosure. Using the emergence of generative-AI information-use controls, we study a distinct margin of corporate information policy: firms' ability to govern downstream uses of information that remains publicly available. Preliminary evidence shows substantial heterogeneity in firms' adoption of AI-related restrictions, with adoption concentrated among firms that previously differentiated among automated agents. We examine whether such controls are used to protect information with greater proprietary reuse value and whether they allow firms to preserve public disclosure when withholding information would itself be costly.

Teaching Experience

Instructor
Cost Accounting, Undergraduate, *Universitat Internacional de Catalunya*; Student Evaluation: 4.03/5 *2026*

Teaching Assistant
Global Operations, Master's, *ESADE Business School*; Instructor: Prof. Annachiara Longoni *2024–2026*

Teaching Training

Case Teaching for Junior Professors, Representative of the Ph.D. Program, *IESE Business School* *2025*

Research Presentations

P = presenting, D = discussing

Financial Reporting and Business Communication Annual Conference (FRBC) (P) *2026*
Glasgow University, Glasgow, United Kingdom

Journal of International Accounting Research Annual Conference (JIAR) (P) *2026*
Korea University, Seoul, South Korea

European Accounting Association Annual Conference (EAA) (P, D) *2026*
Prague, Czech Republic

European Accounting Association Doctoral Colloquium (EAA DC) (P) *2026*
Prague, Czech Republic

British Accounting and Finance Association Annual Conference (BAFA) (P) *2026*
Birmingham, United Kingdom

DAR Doctoral Workshop for Accounting Research with *Luzi Hail* (P) *2025*
JMP selected to present, University of Zurich, Zurich, Switzerland

Accounting Summer Camp VIII Edition (ERC) (P) *2025*
University of Naples Federico II, Naples, Italy

The XIX International Accounting Research Symposium (P) *2025*
Ramón Areces Foundation, Madrid, Spain

IE Business School Doctoral Consortium (P) *2025*
IE Business School, Madrid, Spain

Business Schools for Climate Leadership Conference (BS4CL) (P) *2025*
HEC Paris, Paris, France

Selected Conference Participation and Training

Financial Accounting & Reporting Section Doctoral Consortium (FARS) *2026*
Selected Participant

Deep Learning and Causal AI for Estimation with *Stephen Hansen* *2026*
IESE Business School, Madrid, Spain

Artificial Intelligence in Finance Conference *2025*
IESE Business School, Barcelona, Spain

DAR Doctoral Workshop for Empirical Design with *Laurent Frésard* *2025*
University of Neuchâtel, Neuchâtel, Switzerland

Accounting and Business Research Annual Conference (ABR) *2025*
Universidad Carlos III de Madrid, Madrid, Spain

European Finance Association Doctoral Tutorial and Annual Conference (EFA) *2022*
IESE Business School, Barcelona, Spain

WFI Summer School *2019*
WFI Ingolstadt, Germany

Professional Experience

Management Trainee (Accounting/Finance Track) *2020–2021*
Guizhou Aviation Investment Holding Group
Guizhou, China

Skills

Methods: Textual Analysis, Archival Research, Machine Learning / NLP
Software: Stata, Python, R, LaTeX
Languages: Chinese (native), English (fluent), Spanish and Korean (intermediate)

Grants

Research Grant, *Spanish Ministry of Science and Innovation* *2024–2027*
The Role of Accounting in the World's Global Challenges
Research Team Member; Total Grant Amount: €113,750
Reference: PID2023-150744NB-C41

Awards and Scholarships

The Sue Hrasky Scholarship, *British Accounting and Finance Association* *2026*
Doctoral Consortium Scholarship, *IE Business School* *2025*
Ph.D. Fellowship, *IESE Business School* *2021–2026*
DAAD Summer School Scholarship, *German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD)* *2019*
International Scholarship for Exchange Students, *Korea University* *2019*
Postgraduate First-Class Academic Scholarship, *Xiamen University* *2017–2020*
Postgraduate National Scholarship, *Xiamen University* *2017–2020*
Undergraduate Academic Scholarship, *Shanghai Maritime University* *2015*

References

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Igor Kadach
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Pietro Bonetti
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